the Mongol incursions of the early to mid-thirteenth century, after which apparently neither of these sites fully revived.[17]

The series of events recorded in Juzjani's *textual* narrative seem to concord with the evidence presented by *material* culture – further discussed below. The author's account of the destructive visitations of 'Ala' al-Din Husain *Jahan-suz* upon Ghazna and Lashkari Bazar in AH 544/1150 CE, could have resulted in the first signs of destruction by fire at both sites.[18] The partial date of AH 55x/1156–1165 CE in Lashkari Bazar's South Palace inscription (Figure 5.17) (cf. below) would then indicate intervention(s) at least at *this* site after the destruction. As outlined in Chapter 3, in AH 553/1158 CE 'Ala' al-Din Husain had demanded and eventually wrested Tiginabad/Old Qandahar from the recently defeated Ghaznavid sultan Bahram-shah. This Shansabani territorial gain effectively disrupted the Ghazna–Zamindawar route, preventing the later Ghaznavid sultans from easily traveling to Bust and Lashkari Bazar. The fragmentary date of Lashkari Bazar's South Palace inscription, then, could refer to work undertaken sometime *after* AH 553/1158 CE, when 'Ala' al-Din prevailed yet again over the Ghaznavid forces; this date falls within the decade-long span of the incomplete inscription.[19] But, as argued below, the substantial and large-scale renovations at Lashkari Bazar should be re-dated to a period after the final Shansabani takeover of Ghaznavid territories as of *c*. AH 569/1173 CE and onward.

Ghazna

Recent analyses focused on the marble, terracotta, and stucco architectural fragments ensuing from the Italian excavations at Ghazna – conducted more than a half-century ago (1950s–1960s) – are finally creating a fuller picture of Shansabani interventions here. Prior to these new studies, Shansabani traces at Ghazna appeared to have been extremely meager, limited to a reoccupation of an elite residence in the Rauza hills, overlooking the city's central area (Figure 5.1): here, among the many rediscovered objects was a store of remarkably well-preserved lusterware, which ultimately gave their name to the site as the House of Lusterware. The objects were collectively interpreted as dating to the late twelfth or early thirteenth century, definitely after the first Shansabani sack of Ghazna in AH 544/1150 CE, and likely also after the final victory of AH 569/1173 CE.[20] However, ongoing studies of terracotta architectural decoration, recovered from Ghazna's central palace, profoundly alter the perception of an ephemeral Shansabani presence in the city. It seems that the Shansabani interventions at the palace were more commensurate with their momentous occupation of the capital, and especially the crowning of Shihab al-Din as Sultan Mu'izz al-Din, who effectively appropriated – though with some needed territorial consolidation – the central Ghaznavid holdings encompassing